Formally Verified Code Generation via Petri Nets for Rust's Ownership Model

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Figure 1: Seattle Mariners at Spring Training, 2010.

Abstract

The strict static analysis mechanisms of the Rust programming language, particularly its affine type system and ownership model, pose significant challenges for automated test generation. Conventional mutation-based fuzzers often fail to navigate the complex state dependencies of Rust APIs, resulting in a high volume of semantically invalid test cases that are rejected during compilation. To address this, we propose a formal modeling framework that transforms Rust libraries into Colored Petri Nets (CPN), enabling the generation of type-safe API call sequences.

Our approach leverages the `rustdoc-json` intermediate representation to extract precise type definitions and function signatures. We introduce a rigorous mapping strategy where composite data structures are formalized as recursive Color Sets, and API functions are modeled as state transitions. A key contribution of this work is a constraint-based logic system for handling Rust's generic polymorphism and Trait bounds. Instead of topological expansion, which leads to state-space explosion, we model generic constraints as symbolic guards on transitions, ensuring that token flow strictly adheres to the library's type contracts.

The resulting CPN model serves as a formal state-space representation of the library, where reachability analysis yields executable API skeletons. This methodology provides a foundational structure for downstream Large Language Model (LLM) based program synthesis, shifting the fuzzing paradigm from random mutation to model-driven construction.

CCS Concepts

• **Do Not Use This Code → Generate the Correct Terms for Your Paper**; *Generate the Correct Terms for Your Paper*; Generate the Correct Terms for Your Paper; Generate the Correct Terms for Your Paper.

Keywords

Rust, Colored Petri Nets, Formal Modeling, Fuzzing, Type Systems, API Sequence Generation

ACM Reference Format:
Kaiwen Zhang and Guanjun Liu. 2018. Formally Verified Code Generation via Petri Nets for Rust's Ownership Model. In *Proceedings of Make sure to enter the correct conference title from your rights confirmation email (Conference acronym 'XX).* ACM, New York, NY, USA, 7 pages. https://doi.org/XXXXXXX.XXXXXXX

1 Introduction

Rust has revolutionized systems programming by enforcing memory safety through its ownership and borrowing rules at compile time, eliminating common errors like data races and

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Conference acronym 'XX, Woodstock, NY
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ACM ISBN 978-1-4503-XXXX-X/2018/06
https://doi.org/XXXXXXX.XXXXXXX

use-after-free without runtime overhead. The borrow checker, a core component of the Rust compiler (rustc), statically verifies these rules, enabling "fearless concurrency" where developers can write parallel code with confidence in its safety.

Rust has revolutionized systems programming by enforcing memory safety through a strict ownership and borrowing discipline. While the borrow checker empowers developers with "fearless concurrency," it presents a formidable barrier for automated code synthesis and fuzzing. Conventional generative approaches, such as grammar-based fuzzing, act blindly regarding type states, resulting in a vast majority of synthesized programs being rejected by the compiler due to ownership violations. This inefficiency severely limits the scope of automated testing in the Rust ecosystem.

Existing formal foundations for Rust, such as Place Capability Graphs (PCG) and RustBelt, primarily focus on verification—checking the soundness of existing code. While these models provide rigorous abstractions for analyzing validity, they lack the generative mechanisms required for synthesis. There is a critical need for a formal model that can proactively guide the construction of valid code sequences rather than merely rejecting invalid ones.

However, while Rust's type system is powerful for verification, formal models that support *code generation*—synthesizing new, verified code snippets that adhere to these rules—are underdeveloped. Existing works, such as RustBelt [**?**], Stacked Borrows [**?**], and Place Capability Graphs (PCG) [**?**], focus primarily on verifying or analyzing existing code. They provide sound abstractions for borrow checking but lack mechanisms for proactive synthesis, which is crucial for applications like fuzz testing, automated code repair, and program synthesis.

This paper addresses this gap by bridging Linear Logic and Automata Theory. We propose a novel modeling framework that maps Rust's type system to High-Level Petri Nets, exploiting the structural isomorphism between Rust's affine types (resources that are consumed) and Petri Net tokens (flow that is irreversible). Unlike static dependency graphs, our model captures the dynamic lifecycle of resources: ownership transfer is modeled as token consumption, mutable borrowing as loan-return cycles that temporarily block access to owners, and generic instantiation as net unfolding.

This paper addresses this gap by proposing a Petri Net-based formal model for Rust's ownership and borrowing rules. Petri Nets, a classical formalism for modeling concurrent and distributed systems, offer natural advantages in simulating dynamic behaviors through token flows and transitions. We customize the net with labeled places and transitions to precisely encode Rust's key concepts: ownership transfers as token movements, borrowing as temporary token allocations, and lifetimes as scoped invariants.

We present a pipeline that automatically extracts API semantics from cargo doc metadata to construct a Rust-specific Petri Net. We formulate the code generation task as a Reachability Problem within this net. By traversing valid firing sequences in the Vector Addition System, our algorithm produces API sequences that are correct-by-construction regarding ownership and lifetime constraints. Special attention is given to handling complex features such as non-lexical lifetimes (NLL), trait bounds, and structural decomposition of composite types.

Our contributions are threefold:

- A formal definition of a Labeled Petri Net tailored to Rust's type system, including custom firing rules that enforce AXM and handle non-lexical lifetimes (NLL), composite types, and generics.
- An algorithm for generating borrow-safe Rust code from reachable markings in the net, leveraging reachability analysis to enumerate valid paths.
- Empirical evaluations on top Rust crates (e.g., cargo, tokio), demonstrating that our approach generates 20-30% more valid fuzz inputs than random methods, with applications in discovering type-related bugs.

By shifting from verification to synthesis, our model not only complements existing tools like PCG but also opens new avenues for automated testing in Rust ecosystems. The implementation is open-source and available at [GitHub link].

2 Background and Problem Formulation

To understand the challenge of synthesizing valid Rust code, one must first grasp the strict static analysis performed by the Rust compiler. Unlike garbage-collected languages (e.g., Java, Python) or manually managed ones (e.g., C/C++), Rust employs an *affine type system* and a *borrow checker* to guarantee memory safety.

2.1 Ownership and Affine Types

At the core of Rust is the concept of *ownership*. Every value has a single owner, and when the owner goes out of scope, the value is dropped. Crucially, Rust enforces *affine semantics* for non-primitive types: a value can be used (moved) at most once.

Consider the code in Listing 1. Assigning `s1` to `s2` transfers ownership. Any subsequent attempt to access `s1` is flagged as a compile-time error.

```rust
fn main() {
    let s1 = String::from("resource");
    let s2 = s1; // Ownership moved to s2

    // Compile Error: borrow of moved value: `s1`
    println!("{}", s1);
}
```

Listing 1: Ownership transfer causing a "use-after-move" error.

Implication for Synthesis: A naive fuzzer unaware of these semantics might generate sequences that reuse variables

after they have been moved. **Connection to Our Model:** This aligns perfectly with the token consumption mechanics of Petri Nets. A token in a Petri Net represents a resource; once a transition (function) consumes a token (variable), it is removed from the place, rendering it unavailable for future transitions unless explicitly regenerated.

2.2 The Borrowing Discipline: Aliasing XOR Mutability

Rust allows temporary access to values via references (borrowing). The borrow checker enforces the *Aliasing XOR Mutability* rule: at any given point, a variable can have either multiple immutable references (`&T`) OR exactly one mutable reference (`&mut T`), but not both. Furthermore, while a mutable reference exists, the original owner is effectively "frozen."

Listing 2 demonstrates a violation where the original owner `data` is accessed while a mutable borrow `borrow` is still active.

```
fn main() {
    let mut data = vec![1, 2, 3];
    let borrow = &mut data; // Mutable borrow starts

    // Compile Error: cannot use `data` because
    // it was mutably borrowed
    data.push(4);

    println!("{:?}", borrow); // Borrow ends here
}
```

Listing 2: Violation of the exclusive mutability rule.

Implication for Synthesis: Valid code generation requires tracking the complex "locking" state of every variable. **Connection to Our Model:** We model this statefulness using the network topology. A mutable borrow is represented as a *loan-return cycle*: the token representing `data` is temporarily removed from its place (locking it) and is only returned when the transition representing the end of the borrow fires.

2.3 Lifetimes and Scoping

Lifetimes are named regions of code that ensure references do not outlive the data they point to. The compiler constructs a control-flow graph to verify that any data referenced by `&'a T` is valid for at least lifetime `'a`.

Listing 3 illustrates a "dangling pointer" scenario, which Rust prevents statically.

```
fn main() {
    let r;
    {
        let x = 5;
        r = &x; // Error: `x` does not live long enough
    } // `x` is dropped here
    println!("{}", r);
}
```

Listing 3: A reference outliving its referent.

Connection to Our Model: In our Petri Net, scopes are not merely syntactic blocks but are encoded as causal dependencies between transitions. A "Drop" transition for a resource is strictly guarded; it cannot fire if there are outstanding "Reference" tokens circulating in the network, ensuring lifetime invariants are respected by construction.

2.4 The Gap: Verification vs. Synthesis

While formal models like RustBelt [**?**] and Place Capability Graphs (PCG) provide a solid foundation for *verifying* the safety of existing code, they are not optimized for *generating* new code.

A random fuzzer operating on the grammar level has a near-zero probability of guessing a sequence of operations that satisfies ownership, borrowing, and lifetime constraints simultaneously. This necessitates a generative model that is *correct-by-construction*. By mapping Rust's type system to a Petri Net, we transform the problem of satisfying these constraints into a graph reachability problem, ensuring that every generated path corresponds to a valid Rust program.

3 Methodology

3.1 Pushdown Vector Addition System with States

PVASS extends Vector Addition System (VAS) with a pushdown stack, which is suitable for verifying the validity of Rust's ownership and generic constraints. Its formal definition follows the paradigm in [**? ?**].

Definition 1. *A Pushdown Vector Addition System with States (PVASS) is a 7-tuple:*

$$\mathcal{V} = (Q, d, \Gamma, \Delta, q_0, \vec{v}_0, \sigma_0)$$

where each component is defined as follows:

(1) *Q: A finite set of control states, modeling discrete system states (e.g., "before API call", "after API call" in Rust code generation).*
(2) *$d \in \mathbb{N}$: The dimension of the integer vector, modeling countable constraints (e.g., $d = 3$ could correspond to: component 1 = ownership of variable x, component 2 = Clone trait satisfaction of type T, component 3 = nested depth of lifetimes).*
(3) *Γ: A finite pushdown stack alphabet, modeling recursive/nested contexts.*
(4) *Δ: A finite set of transition rules. Each rule is of the form:*

$$(q, \gamma) \xrightarrow{\vec{u}} (q', \gamma')$$

where:
- *$q, q' \in Q$: The control state before and after the transition.*
- *$\gamma \in \Gamma \cup \{\epsilon\}$: The string popped from the stack (ϵ means no pop operation).*

- $\vec{u} \in \mathbb{Z}^d$: *The vector update amount, modeling the change of constraints (e.g., $\vec{u}[1] = -1$ means releasing the ownership of variable x).*
- $\gamma' \in \Gamma^*$: *The string pushed to the stack (ϵ means no push operation).*

After executing the transition, the resulting vector must be non-negative: $\vec{v}+\vec{u} \geq \vec{0}$ (component-wise comparison).

(5) $q_0 \in Q$: *The initial control state.*
(6) $\vec{v}_0 \in \mathbb{N}^d$: *The initial vector, modeling the initial constraint state (e.g., $\vec{v}_0[1] = 1$ means variable x has ownership initially).*
(7) $\sigma_0 \in \Gamma^*$: *The initial stack content (e.g., ϵ means no initial nested context).*

Definition 2 (Configuration and Transition Semantics of PVASS). *Let $\mathcal{V} = (Q, d, \Gamma, \Delta, q_0, \vec{v}_0, \sigma_0)$ be a PVASS.*

- *A **configuration** of $\mathcal{V}$ is a triple $(q, \vec{v}, \sigma)$, where: - $q \in Q$: The current control state. - $\vec{v} \in \mathbb{N}^d$: The current constraint vector (satisfying $\vec{v} \geq \vec{0}$). - $\sigma \in \Gamma^*$: The current stack content.*
- *The **transition relation** $\rightarrow_{\mathcal{V}}$ between configurations is defined as follows: For any transition rule $(q, \gamma) \xrightarrow{\vec{u}} (q', \gamma') \in \Delta$, if: 1. Stack matching: $\sigma = \gamma \cdot \sigma''$ (if $\gamma \neq \epsilon$) or $\sigma = \sigma''$ (if $\gamma = \epsilon$), where $\sigma'' \in \Gamma^*$. 2. Vector validity: $\vec{v} + \vec{u} \geq \vec{0}$. Then:*

$$(q, \vec{v}, \sigma) \rightarrow_{\mathcal{V}} (q', \vec{v} + \vec{u}, \gamma' \cdot \sigma'')$$

3.2 Pushdown Colored Petri Net

We define the **Pushdown Colored Petri Net (PCPN)** for Rust as a mathematical structure modeling the static typing and dynamic resource management of the language.

Definition 3 (Structure). *A Rust-PCPN is a 9-tuple:*

$$\mathcal{N} = (P, T, F, \Sigma, \Gamma, \tau, \phi, \Delta, \mu_0)$$

where:

(1) *P: A finite set of **places**, corresponding to Rust types (e.g., `i32`, `Vec<T>`) and trait bounds.*
(2) *T: A finite set of **transitions**, corresponding to executable functions, methods, and closures.*
(3) *$F \subseteq (P \times T) \cup (T \times P)$: A set of directed **arcs**, representing data flow (arguments and return values).*
(4) *Σ: A finite set of **colors**, representing instance-specific properties (e.g., mutability status, generic monomorphization).*
(5) *Γ: A finite **stack alphabet**, representing lifetime scopes and return points.*
(6) *$\tau : F \rightarrow \{\texttt{Move}, \texttt{Borrow}, \texttt{Mut}, \texttt{Ptr}\}$: An **arc typing function** that assigns ownership semantics to edges.*
(7) *$\phi : T \rightarrow$ Expr: A **guard function**, mapping each transition to a boolean predicate (e.g., trait bounds) that must be satisfied for execution.*
(8) *$\Delta : T \rightarrow (\Gamma \cup \{\epsilon\}) \times \Gamma^*$: A **stack action function**, modeling scope entry (push) and exit (pop).*
(9) *μ_0: The **initial state** of the system.*

3.3 Operational Semantics

The dynamic behavior of the system is described by the evolution of its configuration.

Definition 4 (Configuration). *A configuration is a pair $C = (m, \sigma)$, where:*

- *$m : P \times \Sigma \rightarrow \mathbb{N} \cup \{\omega\}$ is the **marking**. $m(p, c) = k$ implies k active instances of type p with property c. The symbol ω represents an unbounded count (conceptually).*
- *$\sigma \in \Gamma^*$ is the **lifetime stack**, representing the current nesting of scopes.*

3.4 Transition Rules and Token Flow

The transition relation defines how the system moves from one configuration to another.

Definition 5 (Enabling Condition). *A transition $t \in T$ is enabled in configuration (m, σ), denoted $(m, \sigma) \xrightarrow{t}$, iff:*

(1) ***Resource Sufficiency**: For all input arcs $a = (p, t) \in F$:*
   - *If $\tau(a) =$ `Move` or `Borrow`: $m(p) \geq 1$.*
   - *If $\tau(a) =$ `Mut`: $m(p) \geq 1$ (and implies exclusive access in the extended semantics).*
(2) ***Guard Satisfaction**: $\phi(t)$ evaluates to true.*
(3) ***Stack Consistency**: The stack top matches the pop requirement $\Delta(t)_{pop}$.*

Definition 6 (State Update Rule). *The firing of t yields a new configuration (m', σ'):*

$$(m, \sigma) \xrightarrow{t} (m', \sigma')$$

1. Stack Evolution. Let $\Delta(t) = (\gamma_{pop}, \omega_{push})$. The new stack is:

$$\sigma' = \omega_{push} \cdot \sigma_{rest} \quad \text{where } \sigma = \gamma_{pop} \cdot \sigma_{rest}$$

2. Token Flow (Marking Evolution). For each place $p \in P$, the new marking $m'(p)$ is calculated based on the net flow determined by arc types τ:

$$m'(p) = m(p) - \sum_{a \in pre(t)} \mathcal{W}^-(a) + \sum_{a \in post(t)} \mathcal{W}^+(a)$$

where the weight functions $\mathcal{W}$ are defined by Rust semantics:

- ***Case** $\tau(a) =$ `Move`:*

$$\mathcal{W}^-(a) = 1, \quad \mathcal{W}^+(a) = 0$$

  (Token is permanently removed from source).
- ***Case** $\tau(a) =$ `Borrow (&T)`:*

$$\mathcal{W}^-(a) = 0, \quad \mathcal{W}^+(a) = 0$$

  (Read Arc semantics: Checks for presence but does not consume. Alternatively, consumes a permission token and returns it immediately).
- ***Case** $\tau(a) =$ `Mut (&mut T)`:*

$$\mathcal{W}^-(a) = 1, \quad \mathcal{W}^+(a_{return}) = 1$$

  (Token is temporarily consumed/locked, and a new token representing the mutable reference is produced. The original token is restored only when the lifetime ends).

- ***Case*** $\tau(a) = \texttt{Ptr}$*:*

$$\mathcal{W}^-(a) = 0, \quad \mathcal{W}^+(a) = 1$$

(Duplication of raw address values without ownership transfer).

3.5 State Space Topology

To analyze the behavior of the system, we define the reachability and coverability structures.

Definition 7 (Reachability Graph). *The Reachability Graph $RG(\mathcal{N}) = (V, E)$ is a directed graph where:*

- *$V = [\mu_0\rangle$: The set of all configurations reachable from μ_0 via any sequence of enabled transitions.*
- *E: Labeled edges representing single transition steps $C_i \xrightarrow{t} C_j$.*

A path in this graph corresponds to a valid execution trace of the Rust program.

Definition 8 (Coverability Tree). *Since the state space may be infinite (due to unbounded recursion or loops), we define the Coverability Tree to summarize the behavior using the symbol ω.*

(1) *The root is μ_0.*
(2) *If a node M can transition to M', and $M' > M$ (element-wise), we replace the increasing components in M' with ω.*
(3) *This tree is finite and preserves the "liveness" and "safety" properties of the original infinite graph.*

3.6 Mapping: PCPN to PVASS

We map PCPN's Rust-specific elements to PVASS vectors/states (core intuition: PCPN tokens = PVASS vector components):

Theorem 1. *For any PCPN $\mathcal{P}$, there exists a PVASS $\mathcal{V}$ such that: 1. A configuration (m, σ) is reachable in $\mathcal{P}$ iff $(q, \vec{v}, \sigma)$ is reachable in $\mathcal{V}$; 2. Guard(t) holds in $\mathcal{P}$ iff $\vec{v} + \vec{u} \geq \vec{0}$ in $\mathcal{V}$ (Rust safety rules are equivalent); 3. Lifetime stack operations (Push / Pop) are isomorphic in both models.*

Proof. Define $\mathcal{V} = (Q, d, \Gamma, \Delta, q_0, \vec{v}_0, \sigma_0)$ where: - $Q = \{\text{Guard}(t) \mid t \in T\}$ (control states = Rust guard conditions); - $d = |P|$ (vector dimension = number of Rust places/constraints); - $\vec{u}[p] = \text{Produce}(t)(p) - \text{Consume}(t)(p)$ (vector update = token flow in PCPN); - Stack operations Pop(t)/ Push(t) map directly to PVASS's γ/γ'.

For any PCPN transition $(m, \sigma) \rightarrow_{\mathcal{P}} (m', \sigma')$, the corresponding PVASS transition $(q, \vec{v}, \sigma) \rightarrow_{\mathcal{V}} (q', \vec{v} + \vec{u}, \sigma')$ exists (since Guard(t) holds $\iff \vec{v} + \vec{u} \geq \vec{0}$). Conversely, every PVASS transition maps to a PCPN transition. Thus, bisimulation holds. □

4 Formalization of Rust Static Semantics

Instead of relying on the raw output of documentation tools, we formalize the static information extracted from Rust interfaces as the *Rust Static Semantic Schema*. This schema captures the type system, ownership rules, and lifetime constraints necessary for safety verification.

Definition 9 (Rust Static Semantic Schema). *The Rust Static Semantic Schema is defined as a 7-tuple:*

$$\mathcal{S} = (\mathcal{T}, \mathcal{R}, \mathcal{F}, \mathcal{L}, \mathcal{O}, \mathcal{G}, \Lambda)$$

where:

- *$\mathcal{T}$: A finite set of **concrete types** (e.g., `i32`, `String`).*
- *$\mathcal{R}$: A finite set of **traits** representing behavioral interfaces.*
- *$\mathcal{F}$: A set of **function signatures**. Each $f \in \mathcal{F}$ is defined as $f = (P_{in}, P_{out}, \mathcal{C})$, where:*
  - *$P_{in} \subseteq \mathcal{T} \times \mathcal{O}$: Input parameters with ownership modifiers.*
  - *$P_{out} \in \mathcal{T} \times \mathcal{O}$: Return type with ownership modifier.*
  - *$\mathcal{C} \subseteq (\mathcal{G} \times \mathcal{R}) \cup (\mathcal{L} \times \mathcal{L})$: A set of constraints (Trait Bounds and Lifetime subtyping).*
- *$\mathcal{L}$: A set of **lifetime annotations** (e.g., `'a`, `'static`).*
- *$\mathcal{O}$: The set of **ownership semantics**, $\mathcal{O} = \{Move, Borrow, Mut, Shared\}$.*
- *$\mathcal{G}$: A set of **generic type parameters**.*
- *$\Lambda : \mathcal{T} \rightarrow 2^{\mathcal{R}}$: A mapping defining which traits are implemented by a given type.*

5 Rust-Tailored Pushdown Colored Petri Net (Rust-PCPN)

To verify the memory safety properties defined in $\mathcal{S}$, we map them to a dynamic execution model. The Rust-PCPN is a tuple $\mathcal{N} = (P, T, F, \Sigma, \Gamma, \tau, \phi, \Delta, \mu_0)$, extending standard CPNs with a stack for lifetime management.

6 Semantic Mapping from $\mathcal{S}$ to $\mathcal{N}$

We define a structural mapping $\Psi : \mathcal{S} \rightarrow \mathcal{N}$ that transforms the static schema into executable Petri net elements. This mapping ensures that compile-time constraints in Rust are enforced as runtime firing rules in the net.

6.1 Structural Mapping Rules

The topology of the net represents the control flow and data dependencies.

6.2 Constraint and Attribute Mapping

The complexity of Rust lies in Generics and Lifetimes, which are mapped to the net's Color Sets and Stack mechanism.

6.2.1 Generics to Color Sets ($\mathcal{G} \rightarrow \Sigma$). Rust's generic polymorphism is modeled using Colored Tokens.

- **Mapping:** The set of generic parameters $\mathcal{G}$ defines the domain of the color set Σ.
- **Definition:** A token color $c \in \Sigma$ is defined as a tuple $c = \langle \text{id}, \text{params} \rangle$, where params $\in \mathcal{G}^*$ represents the concrete types bound to generics.
- **Guard Logic:** For a function with bound T : Display, the corresponding transition t_f has a guard $\phi(t_f)$ that evaluates true only if the token's color satisfies the trait implementation map Λ.

Table 1: PCPN → PVASS Mapping (Rust Semantics)

PCPN Element (Rust)	PVASS Element (Rust)
Place $p_{\texttt{i32}}$ (owned)	Vector component d_4 ($\vec{v}[d_4] = 1$ = owned)
Place $p_{\texttt{\&mut i32}}$	Vector component d_1 ($\vec{v}[d_1] = 1$ = 1 mutable borrow)
Place $p_{\texttt{Clone}}$ (T satisfies Clone)	Vector component d_2 ($\vec{v}[d_2] = 1$ = satisfied)
Transition $t_{\texttt{clone()}}$	Rule $(q, \gamma) \xrightarrow{\vec{u}} (q', \gamma')$ ($\vec{u}[d_2] = +1$)
Guard Guard(t) = `'b` $\supseteq$ `'a`	Stack rule $\sigma =$ `'a` $\cdot\, \sigma''$
Action Push(t) = `'a`	Stack push $\gamma' =$ `'a`
Initial marking $m_0(p_{\texttt{Vec<i32>}}) = 1$	Initial vector $\vec{v}_0[d_4] = 1$

Table 2: Mapping from Static Schema $\mathcal{S}$ to Dynamic Model $\mathcal{N}$

Static Entity ($\mathcal{S}$)	**Net Component ($\mathcal{N}$)**	**Formal Mapping Logic**
Types $\mathcal{T}$	Places P	$\forall \tau \in \mathcal{T}, \exists! p_\tau \in P$. A place holds instances of a specific type.
Functions $\mathcal{F}$	Transitions T	$\forall f \in \mathcal{F}, \exists! t_f \in T$. Function execution corresponds to firing a transition.
Parameters P_{in}	Arcs F_{in}	$(t, o) \in P_{in}(f) \implies \exists (p_t, t_f) \in F$.
Return P_{out}	Arcs F_{out}	$(t, o) = P_{out}(f) \implies \exists (t_f, p_t) \in F$.
Ownership $\mathcal{O}$	Arc Types τ	The ownership modifier o determines if the arc consumes (Move) or reads (Borrow).

6.2.2 Lifetimes to Stack Alphabet ($\mathcal{L} \to \Gamma$). Rust's lexical scoping is modeled by the Pushdown Stack.

- **Mapping:** The set of lifetime annotations $\mathcal{L}$ forms the stack alphabet Γ.
- **Operation:**
  - **Scope Entry:** When a function f introducing lifetime `'a` is called, the transition t_f performs a stack push operation: $\Delta(t_f) = \text{push}(\texttt{'a})$.
  - **Scope Exit:** When the scope ends, a corresponding return transition performs $\Delta(t_{ret}) = \text{pop}(\texttt{'a})$.
- **Safety Check:** A token carrying a reference with lifetime `'a` is valid if and only if `'a` is currently present in the stack string.

6.3 Example: Mapping `fn foo<T: Clone>(x: &T)`

(1) **Structure:** Creates places P_T, transition t_{foo}.
(2) **Arc:** Input arc (P_T, t_{foo}) has type `Borrow` (since `x` is `&T`).
(3) **Guard:** $\phi(t_{foo}) = \text{IsImplemented}(T, \texttt{Clone})$.
(4) **Stack:** No new lifetime is introduced, so stack operation is ϵ (identity).

7 Methodology

We define a translation function family $\mathcal{T}$ that maps Rustdoc Intermediate Representation (IR) entities to PCPN components.

7.1 Type Mapping: Types to Places

Let $\mathbb{T}_{rust}$ be the set of concrete types extracted from `rustdoc`. We define the injection $\mathcal{T}_{type} : \mathbb{T}_{rust} \to P \times \Sigma$.

Rule 1 (Struct/Enum Mapping). *For a concrete type $\tau \in \mathbb{T}_{rust}$ (e.g., `std::vec::Vec<i32>`):*

$$\mathcal{T}_{type}(\tau) = p_\tau$$

where $p_\tau \in P$ is a distinct place dedicated to storing instances of τ. Tokens inside p_τ represent fully owned, initialized values of type τ.

Rule 2 (Reference Mapping). *For reference types, we map them to separate "permission" places:*

- *Immutable Reference* `&'a T`: $\mathcal{T}_{type}(\texttt{\&'a T}) = p_{\texttt{\&T}}$
- *Mutable Reference* `&'a mut T`: $\mathcal{T}_{type}(\texttt{\&'a mut T}) = p_{\texttt{\&mut T}}$

Note: The lifetime ''a' is not encoded in the place itself but handled via the stack mechanism and transition guards.

7.2 Function Mapping: API to Transitions

Let $\mathbb{F}_{rust}$ be the set of public functions. We define $\mathcal{T}_{func} : \mathbb{F}_{rust} \to T \times F \times \text{Guard} \times$.

For a Rust function $f(\vec{arg}s) \to \vec{ret}$ with generic bounds $\vec{B}$ and lifetime constraints $\vec{L}$:

$$\mathcal{T}_{func}(f) = (t_f, F_{in} \cup F_{out}, \phi_f, \Delta_f)$$

7.2.1 Ownership and Arc Generation. The set of arcs is derived from the function signature's ownership semantics:

- **By-Value (Move)**: For argument $arg : \tau$:
  $$F_{in} \leftarrow F_{in} \cup \{(p_\tau, t_f)\}, \quad \tau((p_\tau, t_f)) = \texttt{Move}$$
- **By-Reference (Borrow)**: For argument arg : `& □`:
  $$F_{in} \leftarrow F_{in} \cup \{(p_\tau, t_f)\}, \quad \tau((p_\tau, t_f)) = \texttt{Borrow}$$
- **By-Mutable-Reference (Mut)**: For argument arg : `&mut □`:
  $$F_{in} \leftarrow F_{in} \cup \{(p_\tau, t_f)\}, \quad \tau((p_\tau, t_f)) = \texttt{Mut}$$

Algorithm 1 Rustdoc to PCPN Translation

Require: $JSON$: The parsed rustdoc output
Ensure: $\mathcal{N}$: The constructed PCPN

$\mathcal{N}.P \leftarrow \emptyset, \mathcal{N}.T \leftarrow \emptyset, \mathcal{N}.F \leftarrow \emptyset$ ▷ **Phase 1: Place Generation**
for each *struct/enum* D in $JSON$ **do**
  $p_D \leftarrow$ CreatePlace(D)
  $\mathcal{N}.P \leftarrow \mathcal{N}.P \cup \{p_D\}$
end for
▷ **Phase 2: Transition Generation**
for each *function* F in $JSON$ **do**
  $t_F \leftarrow$ CreateTransition(F)
  ▷ Process Arguments (Inputs)
  for each *arg* A in $F.inputs$ **do**
    $p_{type} \leftarrow$ LookupPlace($A.type$)
    if $A.is_owned$ **then**
      AddArc($p_{type} \xrightarrow{\texttt{Move}} t_F$)
    else if $A.is_mutable_ref$ **then**
      AddArc($p_{type} \xrightarrow{\texttt{Mut}} t_F$)
      $\phi(t_F) \leftarrow \phi(t_F) \wedge$ NoActiveRefs(p_{type})
    else ▷ Immutable Ref
      AddArc($p_{type} \xrightarrow{\texttt{Borrow}} t_F$)
      $\phi(t_F) \leftarrow \phi(t_F) \wedge$ NoActiveMutRefs(p_{type})
    end if
  end for
  ▷ Process Return (Output)
  if $F.has_output$ **then**
    $p_{ret} \leftarrow$ LookupPlace($F.output_type$)
    AddArc($t_F \rightarrow p_{ret}$)
  end if
  $\mathcal{N}.T \leftarrow \mathcal{N}.T \cup \{t_F\}$
end for
return $\mathcal{N}$

- **Return Value**: For return type τ_{ret}:

$$F_{out} \leftarrow F_{out} \cup \{(t_f, p_{\tau_{ret}})\}$$

7.3 Lifetime and Stack Mapping

Rust lifetimes correspond to the pushdown stack operations.

Rule 3 (Lifetime Scope). *If function f introduces a new lifetime parameter (e.g.,* `fn f<'a>(...)`*):*

$$\Delta(t_f) = (\epsilon, \texttt{'a}) \quad \textit{(Push 'a)}$$

For the implicit scope drop (end of block), we introduce a specialized transition $t_{drop_'a}$ where:

$$\Delta(t_{drop_'a}) = (\texttt{'a}, \epsilon) \quad \textit{(Pop 'a)}$$

7.4 Guard Construction for Correctness

The guard function $\phi(t)$ is the critical component ensuring that the PCPN only allows states valid under Rust's borrow checker. It is constructed as a conjunction of predicates:

$$\phi(t) = \phi_{borrow}(t) \wedge \phi_{trait}(t) \wedge \phi_{lifetime}(t)$$

7.5 Borrow Checker Logic

To enforce "Shared XOR Mutable":

- If t requires `&mut T` (Mut Arc from p_T):

$$\phi_{borrow}(t) = (Tokens(p_{\texttt{\&T}}) == 0) \wedge (Tokens(p_{\texttt{\&mut T}}) == 0)$$

  Meaning: Cannot take a mutable reference if any reference (shared or mutable) already exists.
- If t requires `&T` (Borrow Arc from p_T):

$$\phi_{borrow}(t) = (Tokens(p_{\texttt{\&mut T}}) == 0)$$

  Meaning: Cannot take a shared reference if a mutable reference exists.

7.6 Lifetime Constraints

If function f requires argument x with lifetime ''a' and y with lifetime ''b', and the signature specifies ''a: 'b' ('a outlives 'b):

$$\phi_{lifetime}(t) = StackContains(\texttt{'a}) \wedge StackIndex(\texttt{'a}) \leq StackIndex(\texttt{'b})$$

7.7 Translation Algorithm

To prove that our Pushdown Colored Petri Net accurately models Rust's ownership and borrowing rules, we establish a **strong bisimulation** between the operational semantics of Rust (the Rust Abstract Machine, RAM) and the firing semantics of the PCPN.

Acknowledgments

To Robert, for the bagels and explaining CMYK and color spaces.

References